

SnapIMS Complete Operating Manual

Architecture, operations, recovery, and release acceptance

Active release v0.15.0 · inventory schema 16 / 16 · August 5, 2026

This guide describes the verified SnapIMS browser interface and operator workflow. Shopify draft creation is the default; live publication requires an explicit typed confirmation.

1. Operating model

Layer	Purpose
Source photos	Immutable operator originals
Import cache	Restart-safe decoding, QR interpretation, and thumbnails
Inventory database	Batches, items, controlled tags, history, and checkpoints
Recognition	Durable provider attempts and evidence
Review/Batch Editor	Human decisions and audited edits
Shopify jobs	Durable draft, live, sync, reconcile, archive, restore, and delete operations

2. Shopify state model

State	Meaning
Draft	Created in Shopify but not live
Published	Active and published to the selected publication
Archived	Inactive on Shopify
Deleted	Remote product permanently removed
Needs Sync	Local/remote state requires action
Conflict	Supported local and remote values differ

Shopify publish workflow

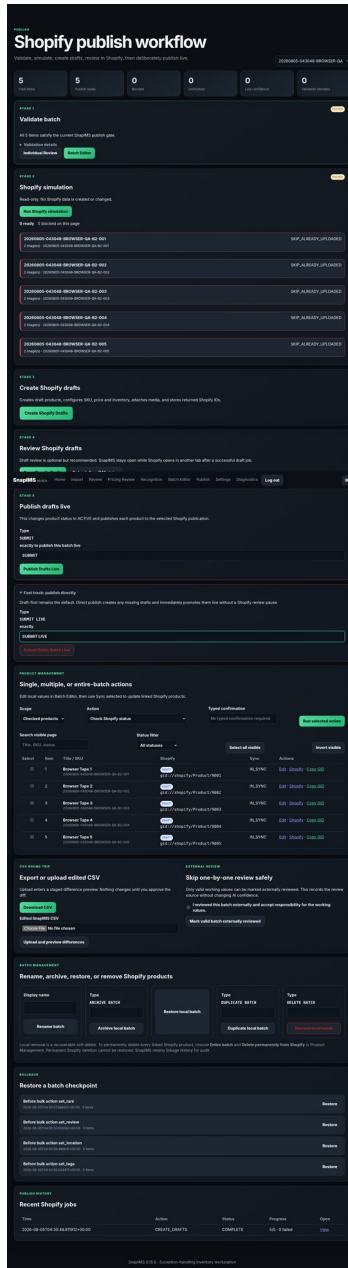
1. Open Publish and select the working batch.
2. Resolve all validation blockers. Live actions remain unavailable while blockers exist.
3. Run Shopify Simulation. Simulation performs no Shopify write.
4. Choose Create Shopify Drafts. SnapIMS uploads only publish-ready items and records Product, Variant, and Inventory Item GIDs.
5. After success, SnapIMS opens Shopify draft products in a separate browser tab. The Publish page also provides Open in Shopify, Copy Product Link, and Copy Product GID controls.
6. Review drafts when desired, then type SUBMIT and choose Publish Drafts Live.
7. For deliberate direct publication, type SUBMIT LIVE. This bypass is not the default path.

Action	Required confirmation	Effect
Create Shopify Drafts	None after successful simulation	Creates unpublished Shopify products
Publish Drafts Live	SUBMIT	Activates products and publishes them to the selected publication
Publish Directly	SUBMIT LIVE	Creates drafts and then publishes them live
Archive	ARCHIVE	Makes selected Shopify products inactive
Restore Draft	RESTORE	Returns selected products to draft state
Delete	DELETE	Permanently deletes selected Shopify products
Keep Shopify	KEEP SHOPIFY	Imports the remote product snapshot into supported SnapIMS fields
Merge	MERGE	Applies the supported conflict merge operation

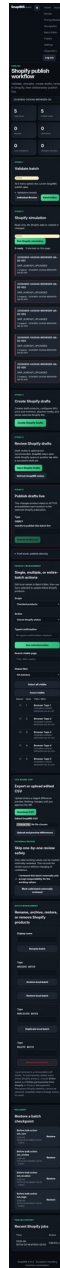
- Use checkboxes for selected-item operations; use the explicit entire-batch scope only when intended.

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- Select All, Invert Selection, search, filtering, sorting, retry, reconciliation, archive, restore, and delete are available from the management section.
- Durable jobs show pending, running, retrying, complete, skipped, and failed rows with progress, elapsed time, ETA, and failure details.
- Restarting SnapIMS recovers unfinished jobs. Completed rows are not repeated.
- SKU reconciliation and stored Shopify GIDs prevent accidental duplicate creation.



Desktop publish workflow browser evidence.



Publish workflow verified at a 390-pixel mobile viewport.

3. Durable jobs and idempotency

- Jobs and per-item stages are stored in schema 16.
- A completed item is not executed again after refresh or restart.
- Concurrent duplicate work is rejected or resolves to the existing durable job.
- Transient failures use bounded retry; authentication failure permits one token refresh and retry.
- SKU reconciliation and persisted Shopify GIDs prevent duplicate product creation.

4. Security

- Client Secret and access-token cache are encrypted and owner-only.
- Secrets are not written to logs, HTML, screenshots, browser storage, or audit details.

- All state-changing browser routes remain authenticated and CSRF-protected.
- Destructive or public-storefront actions require exact typed confirmation.
- Connection testing is read-only; live writes occur only from the Publish workflow.

5. Browser and automated verification

Evidence	Result
Automated suite	299 passed, 3 skipped, 0 failed
Browser checks	52 / 52 passed
Console/page errors	0
Unexpected failed requests	0
HTTP 500 responses	0
Desktop Chromium	Pass through local relay
390 px mobile	Pass
Upgrade from v0.14.0	Pass; schema 16; inventory preserved

6. External tests not claimed

Capability	Reason
Live owner-store product writes	No owner Shopify credentials were available in the sandbox; deterministic fakes covered mutations and state transitions.
Live OpenAI	No production API key in sandbox.
Native Firefox	Runtime unavailable.
Target 2012 Mac mini	Hardware unavailable.
Owner Cloudflare/Guacamole/xrdp	Infrastructure unavailable.
Real HEIC	HEIC runtime unavailable.

7. v1.0 acceptance

- Complete the real 20-tape Pixel pilot.
- Create and inspect real Shopify drafts, then publish a controlled live product and test archive/delete recovery decisions.
- Run live AI, real CSV round trip, restart durability, backup/restore, target-hardware soak, direct Firefox/Chromium walkthrough, and security review.
- Follow the final Operator Guide against the production browser UI and resolve every discrepancy.
- Do not label 1.0.0 while any Critical or High production blocker remains.

8. Evidence locations

- browser-evidence/v0.15.0/
- release-evidence/v0.15.0/
- TEST_RESULTS.md
- BROWSER_VERIFICATION.md
- ISSUE_TRACEABILITY_V0150.md
- V1_PRODUCTION_ACCEPTANCE_GAPS.md